cosmos occurs in the sphere of ***Brahman***'s body and does not affect the divine life as it is in itself.

Ramanuja understands devotion to God (*bhakti*) as a mode of relationship with the personal god *Vishnu Narayana* that will culminate in communion with god in heaven. Devotion is more than feeling. It involves the awareness of one's ultimate dependence upon God, the inner guide. In this world, devotion is expressed in the unselfish observation of one's ***caste***-based social and religious duties (*varna-ashrama-dharma*). It is a response to a profound conviction that if God is the foundational cause of everything, then everything one does is also an action of God. This does not mean that one's actions are not one's own. It means that it is thanks to God's initiative that the dependent soul is itself an entity with its own activity.

See ***Lila***

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Buitenen 1953 and 1956; Carman 1974; Cowell and Gough 1996; Lipner 1986; Thibaut 1904a

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Saccidananda (Being–Consciousness–Delight): this is an *Advaita-Vedantin* expression for the Authentic Reality (***Brahman***). The true reality is unconditioned self-awareness delighting in itself. It is a state of pure tranquillity, beyond all oppositions such as that between knower and known. This is perhaps what the introverted mediator, who has renounced the world of change with all it objects of attachment, frustrations and anxieties, experiences in profound states of contemplation. His experience of unity and peace tells him that the world of differences,